

Role Models: unit planner

A 16-lesson unit in which Grade 3 students explore how the role models people choose reflect their beliefs and values, through folk tales, legends, real-life figures, and their own writing.

Level

Level 5, Grade 3 · PYP Phase 4

Theme

Who we are

Subject focus

Language: reading and writing

Length

16 lessons, one inquiry cycle each

Central idea

Choices of role models reflect the beliefs and values of individuals and societies.

Lines of inquiry

- What determines our beliefs and values
- How and why role models are chosen
- The influence of role models on our choices and actions

Key concepts

Causation

Perspective

Reflection

Learner profile

Risk-takers

Communicators

Learning outcomes

- Discuss the personalities and behaviors of story characters, and why they act as they do
- Relate their own experiences to fiction and non-fiction texts
- Read and discuss myths and legends
- Use a dictionary, thesaurus, and word banks to extend their language
- Use feedback from teachers and classmates to improve their writing
- Understand the difference between a belief, a value, and an opinion
- Recognize that people can influence others' feelings positively and negatively

Approaches to learning

- Communication: reading, listening, writing, speaking, and presenting
- Self-management: planning and preparing their writing

Language

L.3.1 grammar in writing and speaking, including **L.3.1.A** parts of speech and **L.3.1.G** comparatives · **L.3.4** unknown words · **L.3.5** figurative language

Reading: informational

RI.3.1 ask and answer questions · **RI.3.2** main idea · **RI.3.3** sequence and cause/effect · **RI.3.7** use illustrations

Reading: literature

RL.3.1–3.4 recount fables and folktales, find the moral, describe characters, literal vs. nonliteral language · **RL.3.9** compare stories

Writing

W.3.1 A–D opinion writing with reasons, linking words, and a conclusion · **W.3.5** plan, revise, and edit

Role Models: the 16-lesson journey

The unit moves from defining what a role model is, to finding role models in stories and real life, to students choosing how they can be role models themselves.

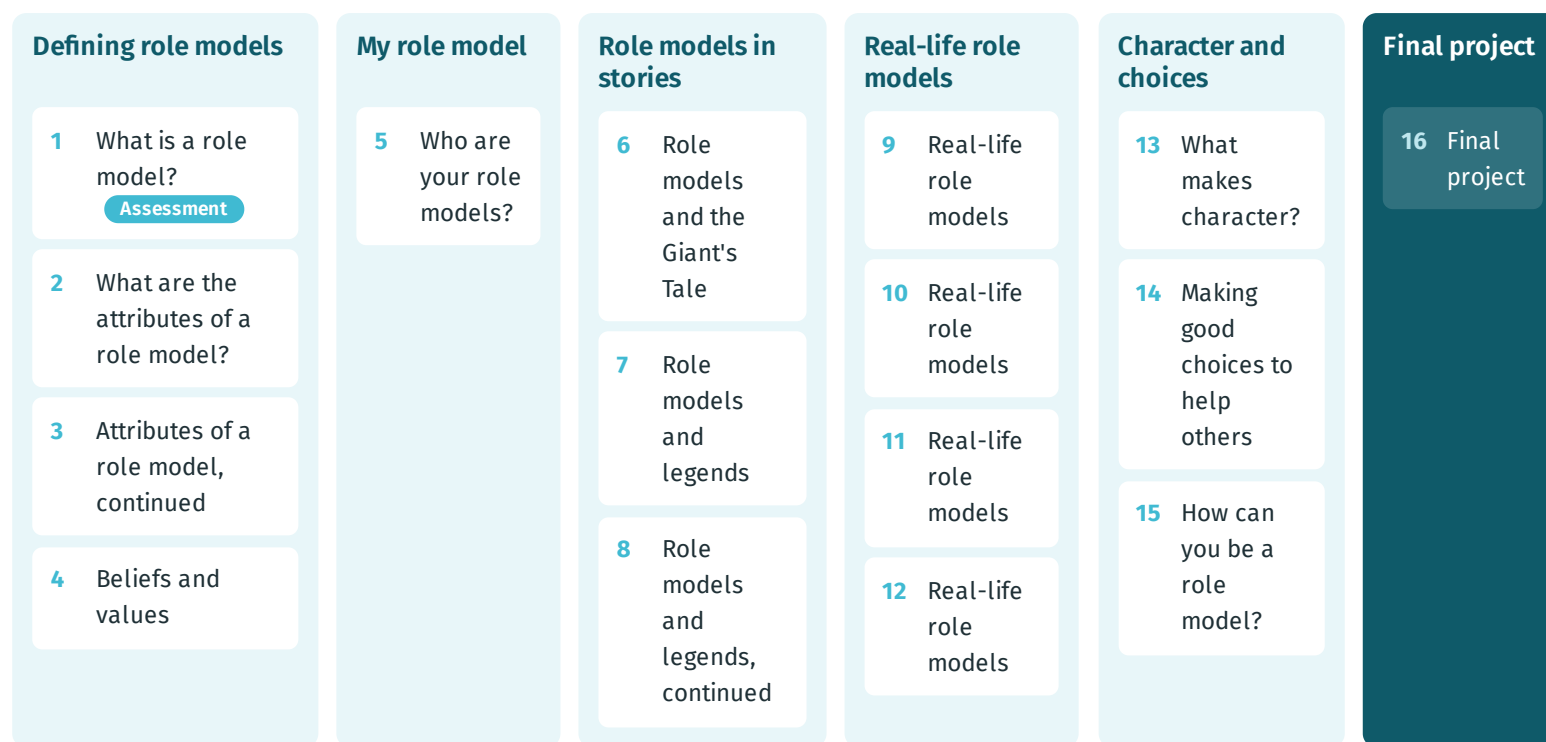
How to read this page

Lessons are grouped into the stages of the unit's inquiry. Lesson materials for the opening stages are shown below.

Assessment

A T-chart of positive and negative role-model traits in Lesson 1, building to a final project in Lesson 16

Lesson sequence



Learning materials for the opening lessons

Lesson 1: What is a role model?

- "Get to know you" board game with an online dice roller
- Sorting activity: attributes of a role model
- Short video: what teens think about role models
- Read "The Monkey and the Crocodile" and make character cards for a T-chart of positive and negative traits

Lessons 2–4: Attributes, beliefs, and values

- IB learner profile puzzle activity
- Stories about characters who show different learner profile attributes
- Values card sort

Lessons 5–7: Writing and stories

- "My role model" opinion writing: planning, a reasons graphic organizer, introduction, rough draft, and closing
- Folk tale and fairy tale flip chart, with an introductory video, Jack's tale, and the Giant's Tale
- Character-trait graphic organizer with the legend of the Giant's Causeway